word, finding the closest Chinese equivalent. Internet is translated using three Chinese characters, each of which has a different meaning but together manage to convey what the new phenomenon is – *'hulianwang'* , where *'hu'* means mutual, *'lian'* means linked together and *'wang'* means net (as in a fishing net). Artificial intelligence in Chinese is *'rengong zhineng'* , a combination of four characters – *'ren'* being human being, *'gong'* work, *'zhi'* knowledge and *'neng'* capability or man-made knowledge creation. There is a whole new dictionary of scientific and technical terms in Chinese which grows with each new edition.

Knowing the language in all its intricacies becomes indispensable to unlocking Chinese culture and gaining insight into the thought processes that lie behind its varied articulations.